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OCTOBER 2026 | DATA TO 30 JUNE 2026

Beyond Tariffs

How Europe's rules are reshaping Vietnam's exports

An analysis of EU non-tariff measures on carbon, forests and food and what it takes to turn compliance into advantage

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Future for All Customers

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Vietnam: the most exposed economy in ASEAN

Situation. Non-tariff measures (NTMs) have replaced tariffs as the main instrument of trade policy in Vietnam's key markets. The European Union (EU) leads the shift. It applies NTMs to 99% of its import product lines and has turned its climate and land-use goals into border rules through the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) and the EU Deforestation Regulation (EUDR).

Complication. No large ASEAN economy depends on Europe as much as Vietnam. Exports to the EU reached USD 56.2 billion in 2025 (10.9% of GDP) and grew by a further 16.3% in the first half of 2026. About four fifths of that trade sits in product groups where NTMs raise costs most. Metals make up 18.8% of exports to the EU, the highest share in the region, while coffee, wood and rubber bring Vietnam inside the EUDR from 30 December 2026.

Question. How large is the exposure, where does it bite and what must Vietnam do to keep its place in the European market?

Answer. By our estimate about USD 45.7 billion of exports to the EU, or 8.9% of GDP, sits in NTM-sensitive groups. On today's steel volumes the CBAM bill rises from about EUR 10 million in 2026 to about EUR 407 million a year in 2034 unless emissions fall. Vietnam has already written most of the required instruments into law. The constraint now is delivery: verified emissions data, plot-level traceability, clean power and the capital to upgrade. We believe the next 18 months will decide whether these rules become a wall or a bridge for Vietnamese exporters.

KEY NUMBERS

USD 56.2 bn Exports to the EU in 2025 (+8.6%)	10.9% Exports to the EU as a share of GDP, 2025	+16.3% Growth of exports to the EU in H1 2026
81.4% NTM-sensitive share of exports to the EU (2024)	18.8% Metal products in exports to the EU (2024)	25.5% Exports to the EU covered by CBAM or EUDR (2024)

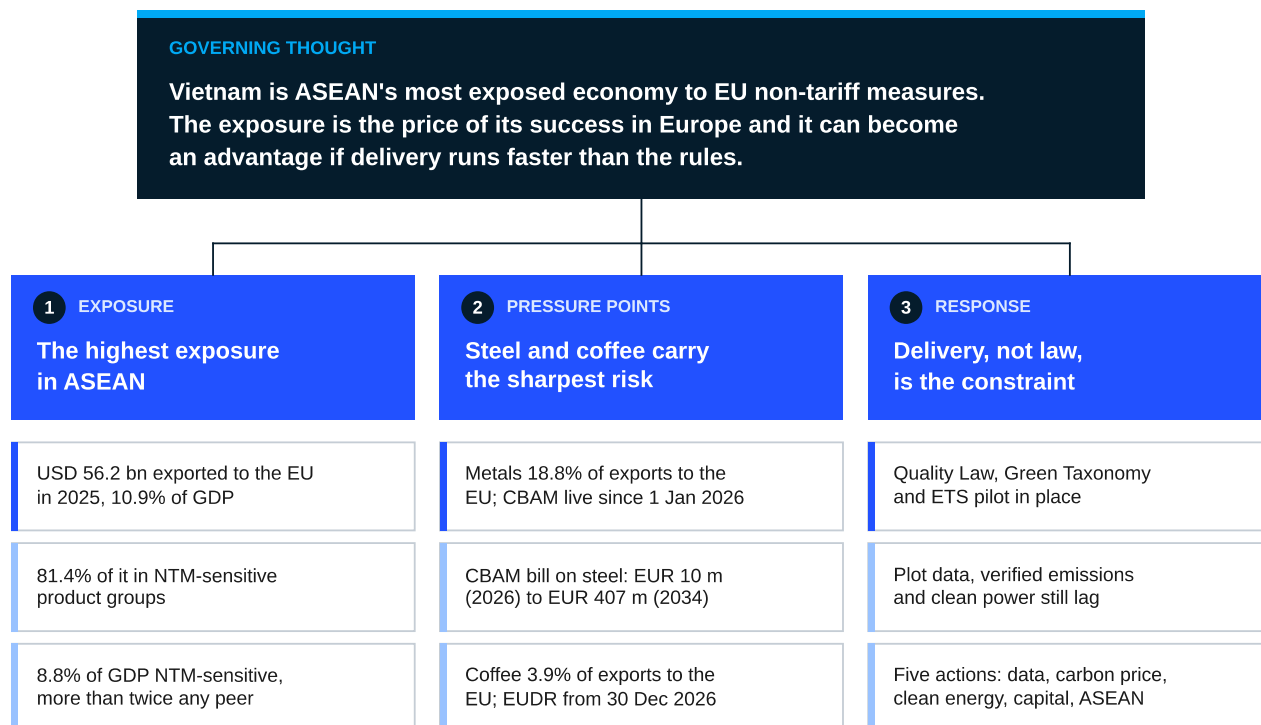
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EXHIBIT 1

The argument on one page: Vietnam's exposure is the price of its success in Europe



Notes: Structured as a Minto pyramid: the governing thought at the top, three supporting arguments and the evidence beneath each. Figures refer to 2024 shares and 2025 values unless stated.

Source: ABrighter Research

01

When Rules Replace Tariffs

KEY MESSAGE

As tariff walls came down a different set of gates went up. For Vietnam the EU now operates the most demanding of them.

- Tariffs fell by half between 2002 and 2021 while compliance costs from NTMs overtook tariff costs.
- Vietnam's export success under the EVFTA has made it the ASEAN economy most exposed to EU rules.
- This report measures that exposure on three dimensions and sets out what Vietnam needs to do next.

Tariffs have fallen for three decades while the rules behind them have multiplied. Since the World Trade Organization (WTO) was founded in 1995 its members have cut barriers to trade through bilateral and multilateral agreements. The global average import tariff fell from around 8% in 2002 to 4% in 2021.¹ Over the same period importing economies turned increasingly to NTMs as a substitute instrument. UNCTAD (2024) found that the cost of complying with NTMs has exceeded the cost of tariffs in recent years.

Vietnam's own history follows the same arc. It joined the WTO in 2007. On 1 August 2020 the EU-Vietnam Free Trade Agreement (EVFTA) entered into force and began to remove most EU tariffs on Vietnamese goods. From that point forward exports kept climbing and reached USD 475.0 billion in 2025.² That placed Vietnam 18th among the world's merchandise exporters.³ As the tariff walls came down a different set of gates went up: standards, certificates, traceability files and carbon accounts.

Tariffs have also returned. Since Donald Trump began his second presidential term in 2025 the United States has raised import duties on most of its partners, Vietnam included. An additional duty of 46% was announced in April 2025 before a rate of 20% took effect in August.⁴ These tariff costs sit on top of NTM compliance costs that were already rising. For Vietnamese exporters the two now act together.

Major economies, including the United States, China, Japan and the EU, use NTMs both to protect domestic industry and to raise standards and pursue sustainability goals. The EU plays the most prominent role. It enforces its NTMs under strict requirements and clear timelines with the aim of protecting its market through harmonised quality standards. Because the EU is one of Vietnam's three largest export markets, these measures bear directly on Vietnam's exports and on the wider economy.

This report therefore examines the EU's NTMs and their impact on Vietnam. It compares Vietnam with Thailand, Indonesia, the Philippines and Malaysia on a common 2024 dataset.⁵ It then updates the picture for Vietnam to 30 June 2026 (the data cut-off for this report) and explains the mechanisms behind each result. The analysis has three parts: (1) an overview of how the EU applies NTMs, (2) an analysis of their impact on Vietnam and (3) a summary of impact levels and policy responses. It closes with the ABrighter perspective.

¹WITS (2023) and UNCTAD (2024) as cited in Krungsri Research (2026).

²Vietnam Customs and NSO, full-year 2025 trade data: exports USD 475.04 billion (+17%); exports to the US USD 153.2 billion.

³WTO (April 2026) as reported by VnEconomy: Vietnam ranked 18th among the world's merchandise exporters in 2025.

⁴Executive Order 14257 (April 2025) and Executive Order 14326 (July 2025); EY Vietnam Customs Alert (August 2025).

⁵Krungsri Research (September 2026), Non-Tariff Measures: Impacts and Challenges on ASEAN. Figures 4 to 6 and Tables 1 and 2 draw on CEIC and Trade Map (2024).

02

Europe's Rulebook

KEY MESSAGE

The EU applies NTMs to almost everything it imports and keeps raising the bar product group by product group.

- NTMs cover 99% of EU import lines and 98% of import value, more than in China or the United States.
- Those three markets took 58.9% of Vietnam's exports in 2025, so almost every Vietnamese export meets an NTM somewhere.
- Three EU measures matter most for Vietnam: CBAM, the EUDR and residue limits on food.

NTMs act like a tax even when their aim is health or climate

Non-tariff measures are policy instruments, regulations and requirements other than ordinary tariffs. Their purposes are to regulate imports and exports, to set product standards and to support sustainable development. UNCTAD classifies them into import-related and export-related measures (Appendix A).

Most EU NTMs are import-related and cover a wide range of areas. They include sanitary and phytosanitary (SPS) measures for agricultural trade and technical barriers to trade (TBT) on product standards, which now include CBAM. They also include quotas and rules of origin. Many of these measures protect health, the environment or workers. For an exporter, however, the effect resembles a tax: a product must be tested, certified, documented or redesigned before it can be sold.

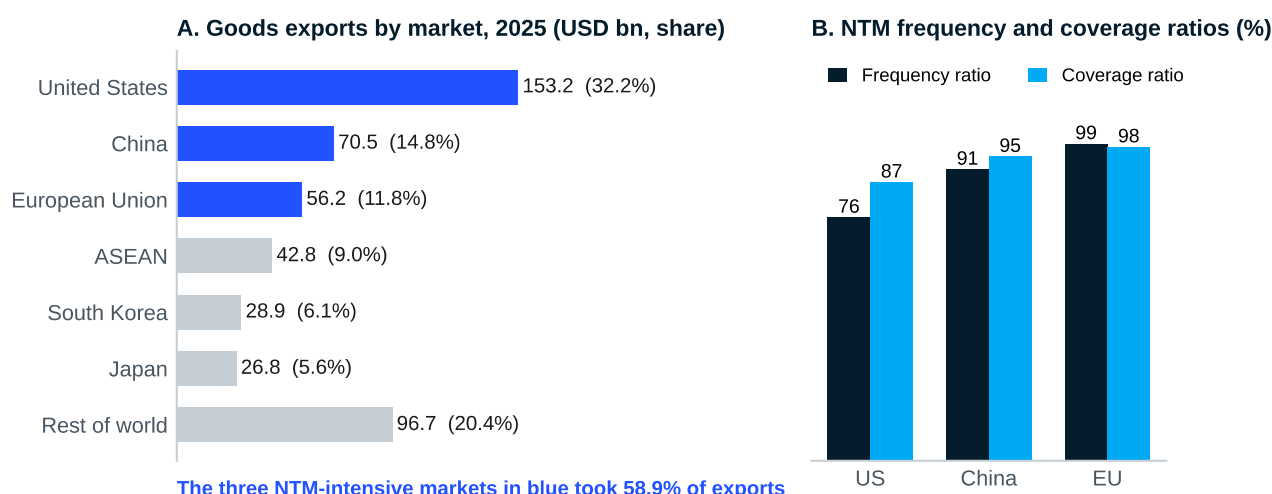
The EU applies NTMs to almost everything it imports

Two indicators show how intensively an economy uses NTMs. The **frequency ratio** is the share of imported product lines subject to NTMs. For the EU it stands at 99%, which means almost every product entering the EU must meet a non-tariff requirement. China and the United States record 91% and 76%. The **coverage ratio** is the share of import value subject to NTMs. For the EU it stands at 98% against 95% for China and 87% for the United States.⁶

⁶UNCTAD, data on non-tariff measures (latest year by country), as compiled in Krungsri Research (2026), Non-Tariff Measures: Impacts and Challenges on ASEAN, Figure 1.

EXHIBIT 2

Close to three fifths of Vietnam's exports go to three markets where NTMs cover most imports



Notes: Panel A: shares of total goods exports of USD 475.04 billion in 2025; rest of world is the residual. Panel B: frequency ratio is the share of import product lines subject to NTMs; coverage ratio is the share of import value.

Source: Vietnam Customs and NSO (2025); UNCTAD (latest year by country); ABrighter Research

The ratios matter for Vietnam because of where it sells. In 2025 the United States took USD 153.2 billion of Vietnamese goods, China USD 70.5 billion and the EU USD 56.2 billion.⁷ Together these three markets took 58.9% of Vietnam's exports. Vietnam's export model therefore depends on passing the inspections of the three regulators with the densest NTM webs in the world.

Three EU measures matter most for Vietnam

Although the two indicators look similar across the three economies, the EU uses NTMs differently in practice. It enforces them across virtually all product categories, whereas the United States and China impose stringent requirements on specific products. The EU also keeps adding requirements that raise standards across whole product groups. The most important for Vietnam fall in two families: technical rules on carbon and land use and sanitary rules on food.

TABLE 1

Three EU measures bear most directly on Vietnam's main exports to Europe

Measure	Family	What it requires	Status at 30 June 2026	Vietnamese exports in scope
Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM)	TBT	Importers report embedded emissions and from 2027 buy certificates at the EU carbon price	Definitive period since 1 Jan 2026; certificates sold from Feb 2027	Iron and steel, aluminium, cement, fertilisers
EU Deforestation Regulation (EUDR)	TBT	Due diligence with plot geolocation showing no deforestation after 2020 and legal production	Applies 30 Dec 2026 (large and medium) and 30 Jun 2027 (micro and small)	Coffee, wood, rubber, cattle products
Maximum residue limits (MRLs) and banned substances	SPS	Residue tests and certification along the food chain	In force; EU moving to hazard-based limits from 2026	Fruit, vegetables, spices, coffee, seafood

Source: European Commission; Official Journal of the EU; ABrighter Research

⁷ Customs data for 2025 compiled by Tradeint (2026): China USD 70.45 billion, ASEAN USD 42.75 billion, South Korea USD 28.94 billion, Japan USD 26.77 billion.

CBAM puts a carbon price on imports in six carbon-intensive groups so that imported goods face the same carbon cost as goods made in the EU. Importers bear the cost of measurement, reporting and verification (MRV) of greenhouse gas emissions. Producers in exporting countries must invest in cleaner processes, for example by moving steelmaking to electric arc furnaces. The **EUDR** covers seven commodity groups with a high risk of deforestation: cattle, cocoa, coffee, oil palm, rubber, soya and wood. Firms must adjust production and submit due diligence and verification reports.

SPS measures set maximum residue limits and ban hazardous chemicals in food and farm products. They raise costs for importers and for every operator along the chain, who must adapt cultivation, testing and certification. Vietnam knows this cost well. The EU checks 50% of consignments of Vietnamese chilli and okra, 30% of dragon fruit and 20% of durian at its border.⁸ Compliance has improved: EU non-compliance alerts involving Vietnam fell from 64 in 2024 to 17 in 2025.⁹ On 29 January 2026 the EU also announced a shift towards hazard-based residue limits, which will tighten the standard further.

⁸Regulation (EU) 2019/1793 as amended; Tuoi Tre News (March 2026); Antidumping.vn (2026).

⁹SPS Vietnam data reported by Tuoi Tre News (March 2026): EU non-compliance alerts fell from 64 in 2024 to 17 in 2025.

03

Measuring Vietnam's Exposure

KEY MESSAGE

Vietnam is the ASEAN economy most exposed to EU NTMs on every broad measure and the exposure is growing with its exports.

- Its largest exports sit in product groups where NTMs raise prices most.
- Its NTM-sensitive exports to the EU equal 8.8% of GDP, more than twice any peer.
- Steel makes it the region's most CBAM-dependent exporter while coffee brings it inside the EUDR.

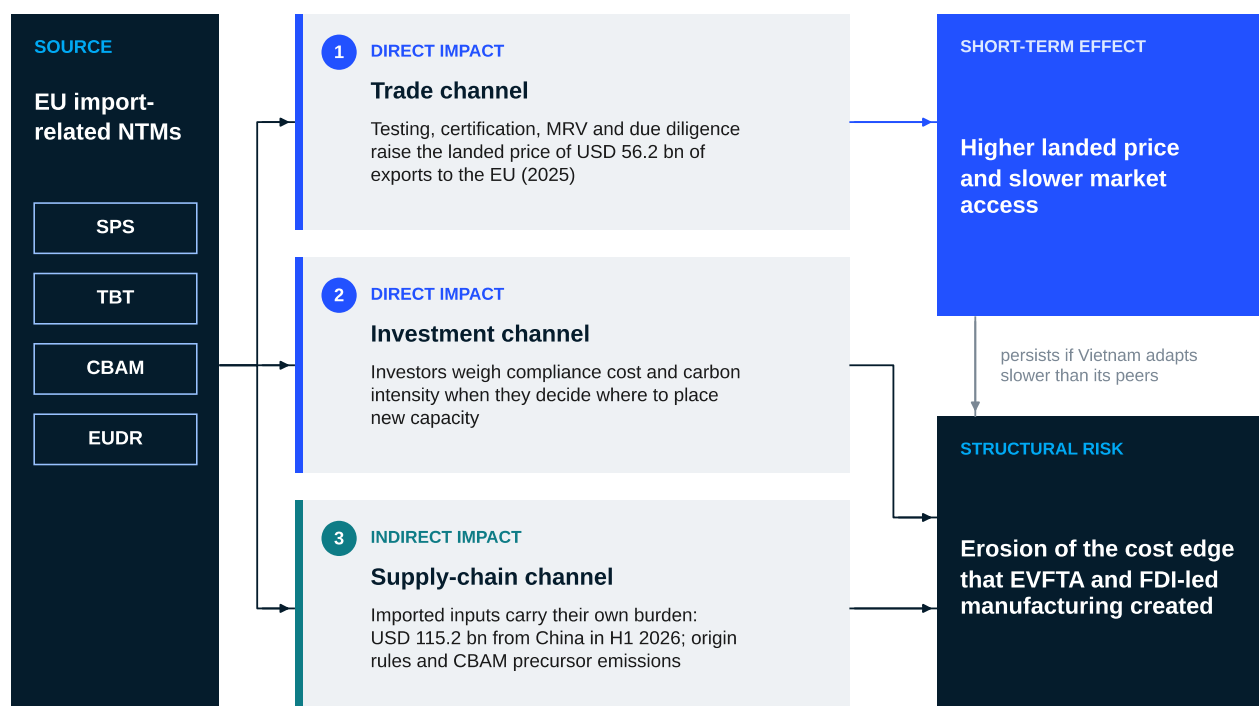
1. EU rules reach Vietnam through three channels

The EU applies its NTMs product by product and not by country of origin. Importers must meet the same standard wherever the goods were made. This is the key difference from tariffs, which are usually set country by country and can be cut through trade agreements. The EVFTA can remove a tariff on Vietnamese goods. It cannot remove a test, a certificate or a carbon account.

As an exporter to the EU, Vietnam faces **direct impacts** through two channels. In the trade channel firms pay additional compliance costs to meet EU requirements, which raises export prices. In the investment channel the cost of adapting to NTMs affects where firms choose to locate production. Vietnam also faces **indirect impacts** through the raw materials and intermediate goods it imports from partners that are themselves affected by NTMs (Exhibit 3).

EXHIBIT 3

EU NTMs reach Vietnam through exports, investment and imported inputs



Notes: Melt and pour refers to the EU steel rule that assigns origin to the country where the steel was first melted.

Source: ABrighter Research using NSO and MOIT data (2025, H1 2026)

The indirect channel matters more for Vietnam than for most of its peers. Much of what Vietnam exports is assembled or finished from imported materials: in the first half of 2026 alone it imported USD 115.2 billion of goods from China.¹⁰ EU rules increasingly look through the finished product to its inputs. CBAM counts the emissions embedded in steel precursors and the EUDR traces coffee and rubber to the plot. A Vietnamese exporter can therefore fail a requirement because of a supplier it does not control.

The first half of 2026 shows this channel widening. Imports grew by 33.4% to USD 283.2 billion against export growth of 21%, turning a surplus into a deficit of USD 16.65 billion. Most of the increase was machinery, equipment and materials for the factories that export. At the level of the economy this is a sign of investment. At the level of the firm it means more of each export carries an input whose carbon, origin and legality the EU may ask about.

The size of the impact depends on three factors: dependence on exports to the EU, the share of imported raw materials and the flexibility of domestic supply chains. If Vietnam adapts more slowly than its competitors it risks losing market share and long-term competitiveness. We therefore assess the impact on three dimensions. The first is the product-group impact measured by the ad valorem equivalent (AVE). The second is export exposure to the EU, both overall and by product group. The third is the impact of the two environmental measures, CBAM and the EUDR.

2. Vietnam's export basket sits where NTMs bite hardest

Agricultural products carry heavier NTM costs than manufactures. UNCTAD and the World Bank (2018) estimated the AVE of NTMs from the price gap between goods subject to NTMs and comparable domestic goods.¹¹ For agricultural and food products the average AVE reaches about 20%. EU import prices for these

¹⁰NSO, socio-economic situation in June and the first half of 2026 (July 2026): exports USD 266.52 billion (+21%), imports USD 283.17 billion (+33.4%), deficit USD 16.65 billion; imports from China USD 115.2 billion.

¹¹UNCTAD and World Bank (2018), The Unseen Impact of Non-Tariff Measures: Insights from a New Database. Simple average AVEs for 40 importing and 200 exporting economies.

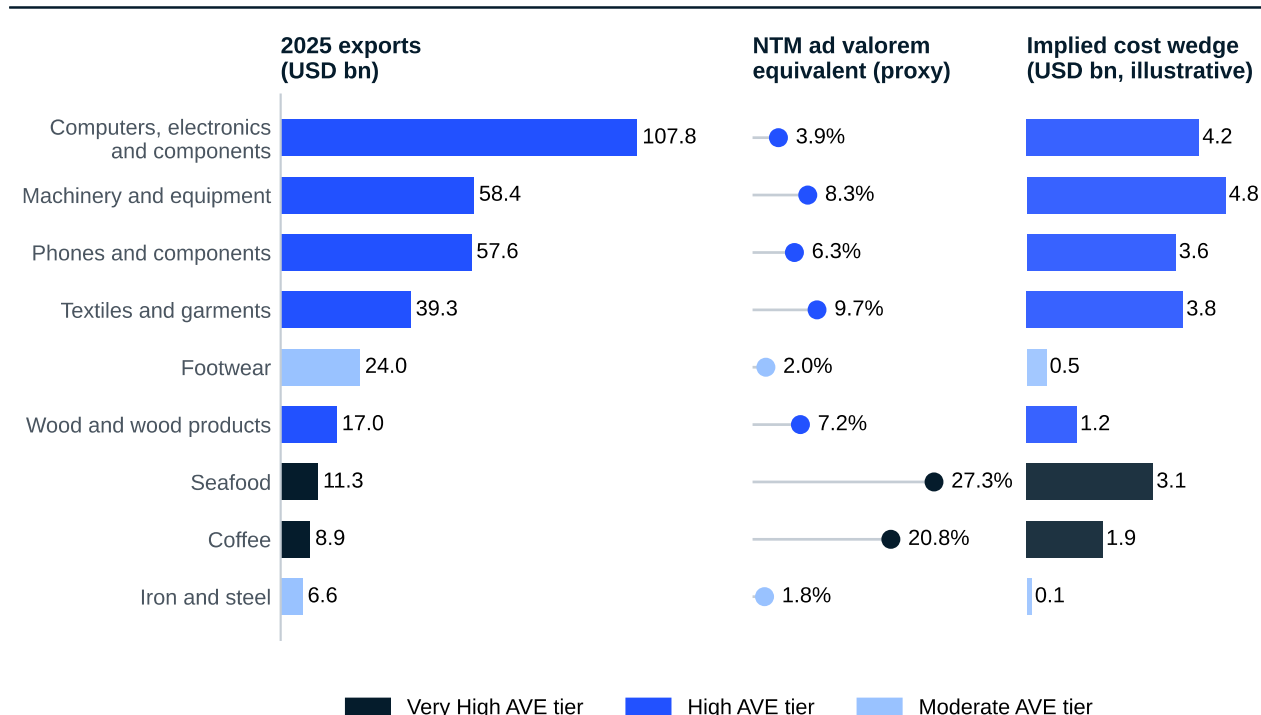
goods are therefore around 20% higher than domestic prices because of NTMs, reflecting quotas, price controls and SPS and TBT requirements. Among manufactures the highest AVEs, at around 8% to 10%, fall on machinery and electronics, motor vehicles and apparel.

On this basis product groups fall into four tiers. Agricultural and food products sit in the 'Very High' tier. Apparel and textiles, motor vehicles, electronics and machinery form the 'High' tier. Chemicals, metals, rubber and plastics make up the 'Moderate' tier. Minerals, oil and gas sit in the 'Low' tier.

Vietnam's export basket sits largely in the top two tiers. The nine largest export items earned USD 330.8 billion in 2025, or 69.6% of all exports.¹² Electronics, machinery, phones, garments and wood products fall in the 'High' tier. Seafood and coffee fall in the 'Very High' tier. Only footwear and steel sit in the 'Moderate' tier.

EXHIBIT 4

Most of Vietnam's export basket sits in product groups where NTMs raise prices most



Notes: AVE proxies are simple averages by product group from UNCTAD and World Bank (2018), mapped to Vietnam's export items by ABrighter Research. Implied cost wedge = 2025 export value x AVE proxy. It indicates scale only and is not an estimate of the cost borne by Vietnamese firms. **Source:** NSO and Customs (2025); UNCTAD and World Bank (2018); ABrighter Research

Multiplying each item by its AVE gives an implied cost wedge of about USD 23.3 billion, a weighted AVE of 7.0%. The figure should be read as a measure of where NTMs bite and not of who bears the bite. The AVE is a price gap that importers, exporters and consumers share between them.

Two features stand out in the ledger. The bright spot is electronics, the largest item at USD 107.8 billion, with one of the lower AVEs in its tier at around 3.9%. Its compliance work is concentrated in large foreign-invested firms that already meet global standards. One must not overlook seafood and coffee, which carry AVEs of 27.3% and 20.8%. These sectors rely on large numbers of smallholders and small processors. The burden per dollar exported is highest exactly where the capacity to comply is lowest.

Who pays the wedge depends on bargaining power. A multinational assembler that sells a phone to a European distributor can pass much of the cost on or spread it across many markets. A coffee farmer cannot. Farmers sell to collectors at a price set by the world market, so any extra cost of testing or traceability tends to come back to them as a lower farm-gate price. Without shared public support for testing

¹² NSO and Customs data for 2025 as reported by Vietnam News Agency (January 2026): eight items above USD 10 billion accounted for 70.2% of exports.

and traceability, the cost of EU rules would most likely fall on the poorest link in the chain. The response to NTMs is therefore a question of rural incomes as well as of trade.

A second shift is under way. Vietnam is working to raise the domestic content of its electronics exports by bringing local suppliers into the chains of foreign investors. As that succeeds, compliance work that multinationals now absorb will pass to Vietnamese small and medium firms. Higher local content is the right goal. It will also widen the circle of firms that must meet EU standards on their own.

3. No ASEAN peer depends on Europe as much as Vietnam

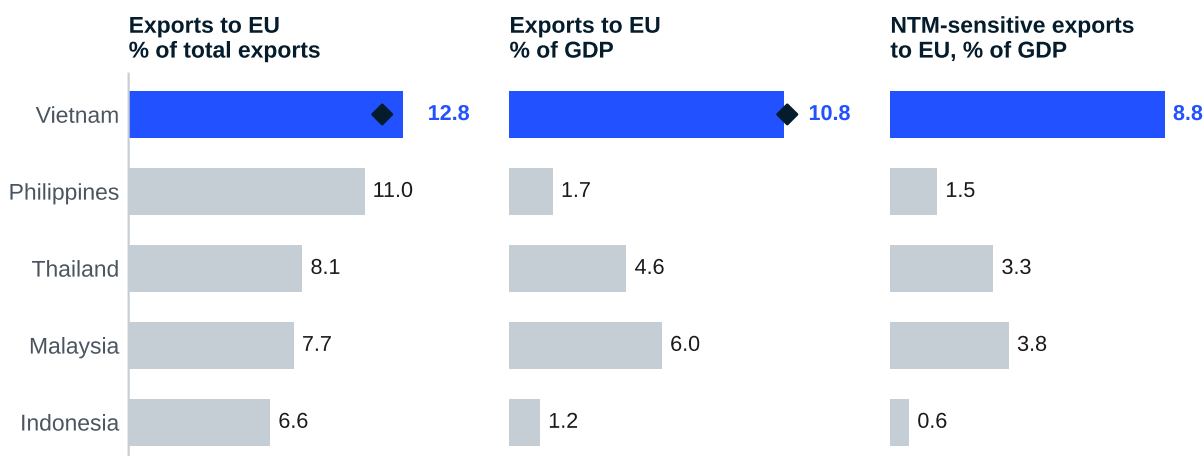
Among the five large ASEAN economies Vietnam depends most on exports to the EU. In 2024 Vietnam sent 12.8% of its exports to the EU, equal to 10.8% of GDP.¹³ The Philippines sends a similar share (11.0%) but that is only 1.7% of its GDP. Thailand (4.6% of GDP) and Malaysia (6.0%) are more exposed than the Philippines and Indonesia relative to the size of their economies. Vietnam's exposure is nonetheless almost twice Malaysia's.

National data for 2025 confirm the picture. Exports to the EU rose by 8.6% to USD 56.2 billion while imports rose by 5.4% to USD 17.6 billion.¹⁴ The trade surplus with the EU reached a record USD 38.6 billion. Exports to the EU equalled 11.8% of total exports and 10.9% of GDP. The momentum held into 2026: exports to the EU reached USD 31.8 billion in the first half, up 16.3% year on year.¹⁵ Vietnam's exposure to Europe has kept pace with an economy that grew by 8.02% in 2025.¹⁶

The record surplus deserves a second reading. For trade policy it shows the success of the EVFTA. For NTM risk it measures how much Vietnam has to lose. A country that sells USD 3 to the EU for every USD 1 it buys has little to offer in return when it asks for flexibility on a rule. Its leverage lies instead in being a reliable and compliant supplier, which is exactly what the new measures test.

EXHIBIT 5

Vietnam's exposure to the EU, measured against GDP, is more than twice that of any ASEAN peer



◆ Vietnam 2025 update using national data: 11.8% of exports and 10.9% of GDP

Notes: Bars show 2024 data. NTM-sensitive products are those in the 'Very High' and 'High' AVE tiers. Diamonds show the 2025 update for Vietnam using national data (exports to the EU USD 56.2 billion; total exports USD 475.04 billion; GDP USD 514 billion).

Source: CEIC and Trade Map (2024) as compiled by Krungsri Research (2026); MOIT and NSO (2025); ABrighter Research

¹³Krungsri Research (September 2026), Non-Tariff Measures: Impacts and Challenges on ASEAN. Figures 4 to 6 and Tables 1 and 2 draw on CEIC and Trade Map (2024).

¹⁴Ministry of Industry and Trade (MOIT), as reported by Vietnam News Agency (2026): exports to the EU USD 56.2 billion (+8.6%), imports USD 17.6 billion, surplus USD 38.6 billion in 2025.

¹⁵MOIT Go Global, EU market bulletin for Q2 2026 (August 2026): exports to the EU USD 31.786 billion in H1 2026 (+16.3%), of which USD 16.72 billion in Q2.

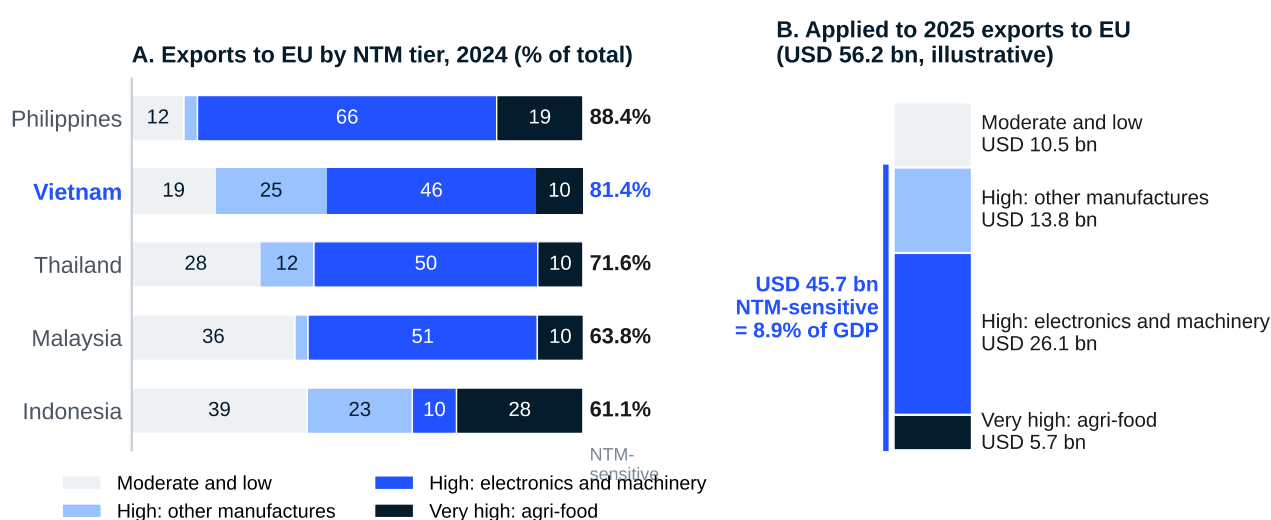
¹⁶National Statistics Office (NSO), Ministry of Finance, socio-economic report for 2025 (January 2026): GDP growth 8.02%, GDP about USD 514 billion.

Combining dependence with product structure sharpens the result. Vietnam's NTM-sensitive exports to the EU amount to 8.8% of GDP and 22.1% of its exports of the same products to the world. Malaysia and Thailand follow at 3.8% and 3.3% of GDP. The Philippines and Indonesia are much less affected. Vietnam faces the highest risk in the region because it combines the highest dependence on the EU with a basket concentrated in sensitive products.

What Vietnam sends to the EU matters as much as how much. In 2024 81.4% of Vietnam's exports to the EU fell in NTM-sensitive product groups. Electronics and machinery made up 46.5%, other 'High' tier manufactures such as garments, footwear and furniture 24.6% and agri-food 10.2%. Only the Philippines, at 88.4%, had a higher share. National data for 2025 support this structure. Computers and electronics (USD 10.89 billion), machinery (USD 7.42 billion) and phones (USD 6.90 billion) together made up 44.9% of exports to the EU.¹⁷

EXHIBIT 6

About USD 46 billion of Vietnam's exports to the EU falls in NTM-sensitive product groups



Notes: Panel A uses 2024 shares. Panel B applies Vietnam's 2024 shares to 2025 exports to the EU of USD 56.2 billion and divides by 2025 GDP of USD 514 billion. It assumes the 2024 product structure held in 2025.

Source: Trade Map (2024) as compiled by Krungsri Research (2026); MOIT and NSO (2025); ABrighter Research

Applied to 2025 values, this structure places about USD 45.7 billion of exports in NTM-sensitive groups, or 8.9% of GDP on our calculation. The figure is close to the 8.8% for 2024, which confirms that exposure has grown in step with the economy. As in most ASEAN economies electronics and machinery account for around half of the total, so the impact on Vietnam is likely to be concentrated in that group. Garments, footwear and furniture add a further quarter. For these products the next wave of EU rules on product passports and supply-chain due diligence will matter more than tariffs.

4. Steel makes Vietnam the region's front line for CBAM

The EU imposes strict environmental standards on imported goods and these reach Vietnam's main exports and supply chains. We assess the two most important measures in turn, starting with carbon.

The rules reward data and penalise its absence

The EU introduced CBAM to give imported goods and goods produced in the EU the same carbon cost. It also aims to prevent carbon leakage, the relocation of production to countries with weaker environmental standards. CBAM covers six product groups: iron and steel, aluminium, cement, fertilisers, electricity and

¹⁷ Ministry of Industry and Trade (MOIT), as reported by Vietnam News Agency (2026): exports to the EU USD 56.2 billion (+8.6%), imports USD 17.6 billion, surplus USD 38.6 billion in 2025.

hydrogen. It came into force on 1 January 2026 with plans to extend its scope to other carbon-intensive products in later phases.

The rules for the definitive period were adjusted before it began. The CBAM Omnibus, in force since 20 October 2025, exempts importers that bring in less than 50 tonnes a year of covered goods and delays the sale of certificates until February 2027.¹⁸ Two further features matter for Vietnam. The charge applies only to the share of emissions no longer covered by free allocation in the EU, which starts at 2.5% in 2026 and reaches 100% in 2034.¹⁹ An importer without verified emissions data must use default values with a mark-up of 10% in 2026, 20% in 2027 and 30% from 2028.²⁰

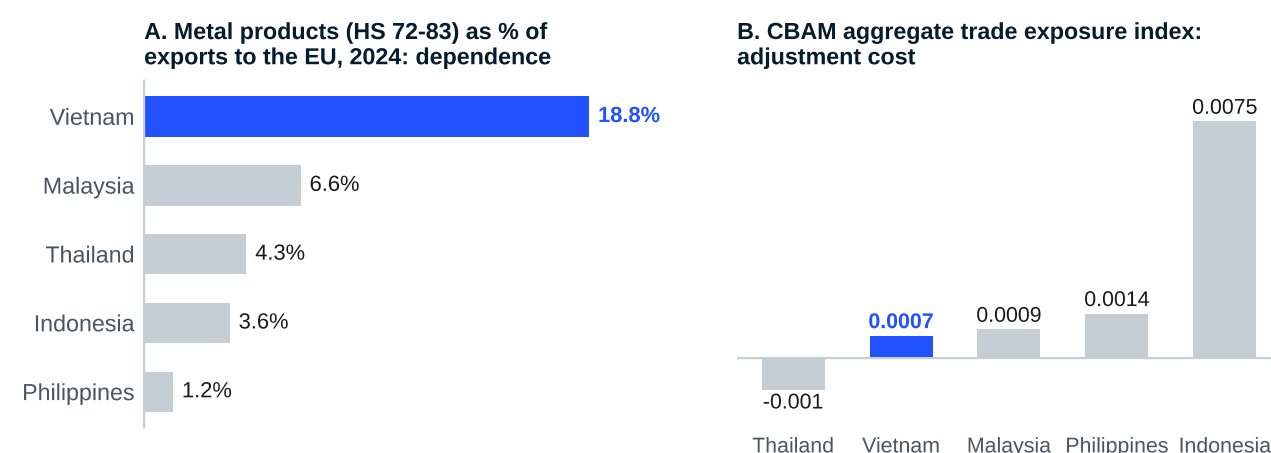
Dependence is high while adjustment cost is still moderate

At product level, metal products (HS 72 to 83) are the most affected. Among the five large ASEAN economies Vietnam has the highest dependence on metal exports to the EU at 18.8% of its exports to the bloc. Malaysia (6.6%), Thailand (4.3%), Indonesia (3.6%) and the Philippines (1.2%) follow.²¹ Vietnam is therefore clearly more exposed to CBAM-related risk than its neighbours.

CBAM also raises adjustment costs. Firms must change production to cut emissions and may have to replace imported steel or metal inputs with greener and more expensive ones. The CBAM aggregate trade exposure index captures this by measuring the extra carbon cost relative to the export value of CBAM-covered products. Indonesia scores highest at 0.0075 because its metal industry spans the whole chain, including carbon-intensive smelting. Vietnam scores 0.0007.

EXHIBIT 7

Vietnam depends on metal exports to the EU more than any peer but its adjustment cost is still moderate



Notes: Panel A: share of metal products in total exports to the EU. Panel B: additional carbon cost relative to the export value of CBAM-covered products; a higher index means a higher adjustment cost.

Source: Trade Map (2024) and World Bank as compiled by Krungsri Research (2026)

The two panels tell different stories for a clear reason. Most of Vietnam's metal exports are intermediate and finished products rather than upstream smelter output, so the carbon embedded per dollar exported is lower than Indonesia's. Taking dependence and adjustment cost together, Indonesia is the most affected country and Vietnam follows. Malaysia, Thailand and the Philippines face moderate impacts.

That advantage may narrow. On 17 December 2025 the Commission proposed to extend CBAM to about 180 downstream steel and aluminium products and to tighten anti-circumvention rules.²² If adopted, the

¹⁸Regulation (EU) 2025/2083 (CBAM Omnibus), in force 20 October 2025; EY Global Tax Alert (22 October 2025).

¹⁹Directive 2003/87/EC as amended by Directive (EU) 2023/959, Article 10a(1a): CBAM factor of 97.5% in 2026 falling to zero in 2034.

²⁰Commission implementing acts on CBAM default values (December 2025), summarised by RMIT Vietnam (January 2026) and MOIT (2026).

²¹Krungsri Research (September 2026), Non-Tariff Measures: Impacts and Challenges on ASEAN. Figures 4 to 6 and Tables 1 and 2 draw on CEIC and Trade Map (2024).

²²European Commission proposal COM(2025) 989 of 17 December 2025 to extend CBAM to downstream goods; Mayer Brown (18 December 2025).

downstream position that protects Vietnam today would bring more of its exports into scope. The emissions gap at home adds to the risk. Industry estimates put the average intensity of Vietnamese steel at 2.51 tonnes of CO₂ per tonne against a global average of 1.85.²³ Crude steel output reached a five-year high of 24.7 million tonnes in 2025.²⁴

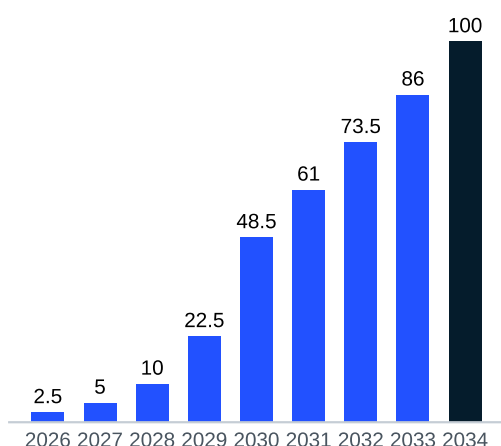
The bill rises forty-fold by 2034

In 2025 Vietnam exported 10.06 million tonnes of steel worth USD 6.63 billion. The EU took about 2.08 million tonnes worth close to USD 1.4 billion, more than a fifth of the total.²⁵ To size the CBAM bill on that volume we apply Vietnam's average intensity of 2.51 tonnes and an EU carbon price of EUR 78 per tonne, close to the 2026 average to August.²⁶

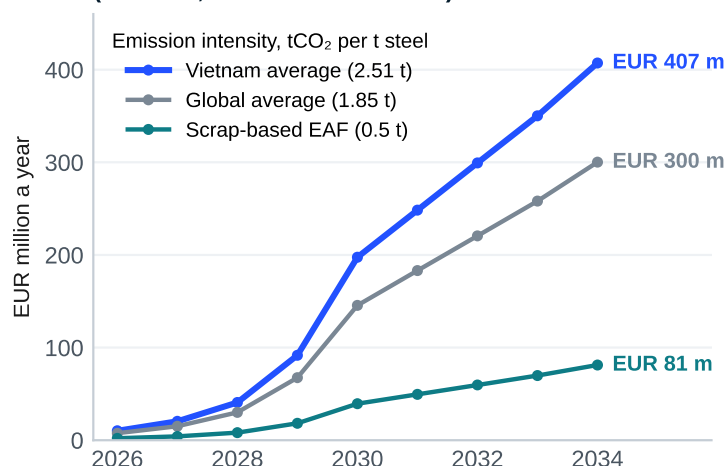
EXHIBIT 8

The CBAM bill on Vietnamese steel is small in 2026 but could reach about EUR 400 million a year by 2034

A. CBAM obligation payable as EU free allocation is phased out (%)



B. Illustrative CBAM bill on 2.08 Mt sent to the EU (EUR 78/t, volumes held at 2025)



Notes: Panel A: 100% minus the CBAM factor under the EU ETS Directive. Panel B is an ABrighter Research scenario: 2.08 Mt x emission intensity x EUR 78/t x share in Panel A. It holds volumes, prices and intensity constant and ignores the benchmark-based adjustment for free allocation, so it overstates the bill in the early years.

Source: Directive (EU) 2023/959; VSA (2025); industry estimates; GMK Center and Carbon Pulse (2026); ABrighter Research

Our scenario puts the bill at only about EUR 10 million in 2026. It rises to around EUR 198 million in 2030 as EU free allocation halves and to about EUR 407 million a year at full phase-in, or EUR 196 per tonne. Set against the unit value of steel sent to the EU in 2025, about USD 673 per tonne, EUR 196 equals 29% to 35% of the price for any euro-dollar rate between 1.0 and 1.2. Commodity steel margins cannot absorb a cost of that size.

The same scenario shows the reward for adapting. At the global average intensity the full bill falls to about EUR 300 million. For scrap-based electric arc furnaces (EAF) at about 0.5 tonnes it falls to about EUR 81 million. The gap between EUR 407 million and EUR 81 million is the value of decarbonising. Firms that cannot show verified data would pay on default values that are higher still.

²³Vietstock (November 2025), How Vietnam can ensure greener steel, citing industry estimates: 2.51 tCO₂ per tonne of crude steel in Vietnam against a global average of 1.85.

²⁴VSA via The Investor (January 2026): crude steel output of 24.7 million tonnes in 2025 (+12%).

²⁵Vietnam Steel Association (VSA) data for 2025 as reported by the WTO Integration Centre of VCCI (2026): 10.06 million tonnes worth USD 6.63 billion; EU about 2.08 million tonnes and close to USD 1.4 billion.

²⁶GMK Center (May to July 2026) and Carbon Pulse (July 2026): EUAs above EUR 90/t in January 2026, EUR 74 to 79/t in May 2026; 2026 average of EUR 78.27/t to 31 August 2026.

5. Coffee places Vietnam inside the EUDR

The EUDR covers seven groups of commodities and derived products with a high risk of deforestation: cattle, cocoa, coffee, oil palm, rubber, soya and wood. Products must not come from land associated with forest clearance and must be produced in line with land-use, environmental and labour laws. Operators must submit due diligence statements in line with EU requirements. In December 2025 the EU postponed application by one year.²⁷ It now applies to large and medium operators from 30 December 2026 and to micro and small operators from 30 June 2027. On 4 May 2026 the Commission published a simplification package and confirmed there would be no further delay.

EXHIBIT 9

About USD 3.8 billion of Vietnam's exports to the EU falls under the EUDR, led by coffee



Notes: Panel A applies 2024 shares of exports to the EU (coffee 3.9%, wood 1.5%, rubber 1.3%) to 2025 exports to the EU of USD 56.2 billion. Leather made from cattle hides, which is also in scope, is not included.

Source: Trade Map (2024) as compiled by Krungsri Research (2026); MOIT (2025); European Commission; MAE (2025); ABrighter Research

Full application will affect ASEAN exports to differing degrees. Indonesia is likely to be hit hardest because palm oil and timber made up 18.9% and 5.8% of its exports to the EU in 2024. Malaysia follows through palm oil and rubber. Thailand is affected through rubber. **Vietnam is affected mainly through coffee**, which accounts for 3.9% of its exports to the EU, with wood (1.5%) and rubber (1.3%) behind.²⁸

Coffee's weight has grown since 2024. Vietnam exported about 1.6 million tonnes of coffee in 2025 worth a record USD 8.92 billion, up 58.8% in value on higher world prices.²⁹ Germany, Italy and Spain were the three largest buyers with 13.7%, 7.8% and 7.1% of the total. On 2024 shares about USD 2.2 billion of coffee went to the EU in 2025. Wood and forest products earned a record USD 17.2 billion, of which around 5% went directly to the EU.³⁰ The rubber industry earned about USD 11 billion including processed goods. The EU took 7.4% of rubber export value.³¹

The coffee price boom changes the economics of compliance. The cost of mapping a plot or filing a due diligence statement does not rise with the price of coffee, yet the export value of the crop it protects rose by almost 60% in 2025. Compliance is therefore cheaper per dollar of sales than at any point in the last decade. If prices fall back before the systems are built, the same work will weigh more heavily on margins. The window to invest is now.

²⁷ Regulation (EU) 2025/2650 amending the EUDR (December 2025); European Commission report COM(2026) 191 of 4 May 2026.

²⁸ Krungsri Research (September 2026), Non-Tariff Measures: Impacts and Challenges on ASEAN. Figures 4 to 6 and Tables 1 and 2 draw on CEIC and Trade Map (2024).

²⁹ Vietnam Coffee and Cocoa Association (VICOFA) and Customs data for 2025: about 1.6 million tonnes, USD 8.92 billion (+58.8% in value).

³⁰ Vietnam Timber and Forest Products Association data reported by Vietnam News (2026): record exports of USD 17.2 billion for wood and forest products; direct exports to the EU at around 4.8% to 5.2%.

³¹ Vietnam Rubber Association (VRA), December 2025: industry exports about USD 11 billion including processed products and rubberwood; the EU took 7.4% of rubber export value.

In May 2025 the Commission classified Vietnam as a **low-risk** country.³² Only about 1% of operators sourcing from Vietnam will be checked and simplified due diligence applies. Low risk does not mean low work. Operators must still collect the geolocation of each plot and evidence of legal production. Two features of Vietnamese supply make this hard. Smallholders supply 63% of raw rubber and most of the coffee. Vietnam also imports raw material: more than 64% of its rubber imports come from Cambodia. Vietnam's low-risk status does not extend to land in another country.

The domestic response has begun. The Ministry of Agriculture and Environment (MAE) has asked every province to publish forest boundary maps by 31 December 2026 and to identify coffee, rubber and timber areas at risk.³³ Provinces in the Central Highlands are piloting deforestation-free coffee with plot polygons uploaded to mobile traceability systems. Early evidence suggests compliance can pay: Vietnam Rubber Group sold about 10,000 tonnes of EUDR-compliant rubber in 2025 and the first half of 2026 at a premium of USD 120 to 250 per tonne.³⁴

6. Together the two measures cover a quarter of exports to the EU

Taking CBAM and the EUDR together, Indonesia is the most affected ASEAN economy ('High'). Products covered by the two measures make up 35.9% of its exports to the EU, mainly palm oil. Vietnam and Malaysia follow with 'Moderate-High' impacts (Table 2). Vietnam has the largest share of metal exports and is therefore more exposed to CBAM, while Malaysia is more affected by the EUDR. Thailand is affected mainly through rubber and metals. The Philippines faces limited impacts from both.

TABLE 2

One quarter of Vietnam's exports to the EU falls under CBAM or the EUDR, mostly through metals

Measure	Product	Vietnam	Indonesia	Malaysia	Thailand	Philippines
Exposure level		Moderate-High	High	Moderate-High	Moderate	Low
Share in exports to the EU		25.5%	35.9%	22.3%	11.9%	2.9%
EUDR	Cocoa	<0.5%	2.6%	1.2%	<0.5%	<0.5%
EUDR	Coffee	3.9%	1.9%	<0.5%	<0.5%	<0.5%
EUDR	Oil palm	<0.5%	18.9%	9.4%	<0.5%	<0.5%
EUDR	Rubber	1.3%	3.2%	3.8%	6.9%	0.8%
EUDR	Wood	1.5%	5.8%	1.4%	0.7%	0.9%
CBAM	Metal	18.8%	3.6%	6.6%	4.3%	1.2%

Source: Trade Map (2024) as compiled by Krungsri Research (2026). Cattle and soya are below 0.5% for all five economies.

³²Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2025/1093 on country benchmarking (May 2025); Ministry of Agriculture and Environment (MAE), May 2025.

³³MAE Forestry and Forest Protection Department action plan on EUDR adaptation, reported by Vietnam News (February 2026).

³⁴Vietnam Rubber Group (VRG) as reported by Nong nghiep va Moi truong (July 2026): about 10,000 tonnes of EUDR-compliant rubber sold in 2025 and H1 2026 at a premium of USD 120 to 250 per tonne.

04

Scoring the Risk, Mapping the Response

KEY MESSAGE

Vietnam is the only large ASEAN economy rated 'High'. It has written most of the required instruments into law; delivery is now the constraint.

- The rating combines overall exposure, product-level exposure and exposure to CBAM and the EUDR.
- Investment incentives and clean-energy plans are in place but reach exporters slowly.
- Verification systems, plot data and green finance are the gaps that matter most.

The overall impact of NTMs combines three dimensions: (1) overall export exposure to the EU, (2) product-level exposure and (3) exposure to specific measures, namely CBAM and the EUDR. The third dimension carries a lower weight because it covers only certain products and so has a narrower scope. On that basis Vietnam is the only one of the five economies rated 'High' (Table 3).

TABLE 3

Vietnam is the only large ASEAN economy rated 'High' for exposure to EU NTMs

Dimension	Vietnam	Indonesia	Thailand	Malaysia	Philippines
Exposure to EU NTMs	High	Moderate-High	Moderate-High	Moderate-High	Moderate
1) Overall export exposure (Exhibit 5)	High	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate
2) Product-level exposure (Exhibits 5 and 6)	High	Moderate	Moderate-High	Moderate	Moderate-High
3) Specific measures: CBAM and EUDR (Table 2)	Moderate-High	High	Moderate	Moderate-High	Limited

Source: Krungsri Research (2026)

- **'High' impact: Vietnam.** It depends on the EU more than any peer, both for exports overall and at product-group level.
- **'Moderate-High' impact: Indonesia, Malaysia and Thailand.** Indonesia and Malaysia are more exposed to CBAM and the EUDR. Thailand is affected mainly through rubber and electronics.
- **'Moderate' impact: the Philippines.** It relies heavily on electronics exports to the EU but is less affected by the environmental measures.

A 'High' rating reflects success in Europe rather than failure

Vietnam is exposed because it has succeeded in the EU market and sells more there relative to its economy than any peer. Table 4 sets out the evidence behind each dimension of the rating and what has changed since 2024.

TABLE 4

The evidence behind Vietnam's 'High' rating has strengthened since 2024

Dimension	Rating	Evidence in 2024	Update to June 2026	What it means for Vietnam
1) Overall export exposure	High	12.8% of exports and 10.8% of GDP went to the EU	USD 56.2 bn in 2025 (10.9% of GDP); +16.3% in H1 2026	Exposure grows with exports; it will not fall unless Vietnam sells less to Europe
2) Product-level exposure	High	81.4% of exports to the EU NTM-sensitive; 8.8% of GDP	About USD 45.7 bn NTM-sensitive (8.9% of GDP)	Electronics and machinery carry the scale; agri-food carries the highest cost per dollar
3) CBAM and EUDR	Moderate-High	25.5% of exports to the EU in scope; metals 18.8%; coffee 3.9%	CBAM definitive since Jan 2026; EUDR from 30 Dec 2026; coffee exports a record USD 8.92 bn	Data quality decides the bill: verified emissions and plot geolocation

Source: Krungsri Research (2026); MOIT and NSO (2025, 2026); ABrighter Research

Beyond the EU, NTMs imposed by other economies are also spreading. They are likely to raise product costs and push firms to change processes and supply chains. Such adjustment needs resources and time. It also needs government support through better regulation and through measures that encourage long-term investment. In this context Vietnam, like its neighbours, has begun to put measures in place to soften the impact of NTMs and strengthen trade competitiveness.

Vietnam has the laws but delivery is the constraint

ASEAN economies' responses fall into two areas. The first is **investment promotion**. Most have introduced incentives in target industries, which lower adjustment costs and raise competitiveness. Further incentives are still needed to help firms upgrade to meet NTMs and raise environmental standards in key sectors. Indonesia, Thailand and Malaysia stand out in attracting investment, while the Philippines offers relatively limited incentives. The second is **regulatory adjustment and enabling infrastructure**. Thailand and Malaysia have relatively complete infrastructure and policy tools for adjustment and product-standard upgrading. Vietnam and Indonesia show strength in clean-energy investment.

Vietnam's enabling infrastructure rates 'Medium' in the regional comparison, behind Thailand and Malaysia. Its investment promotion targets renewable energy, research and development in green technology and a Green Credit Programme of soft loans for green investment. On regulation it has amended its product standards legislation to introduce digital certification and require traceability. Table 5 sets out the instruments and the gaps we see.

The comparison with neighbours is instructive. Malaysia and Indonesia built national certification schemes for their main EUDR commodity: the Malaysian Sustainable Palm Oil (MSPO) and Indonesian Sustainable Palm Oil (ISPO) standards. Thailand's Cabinet approved an excise carbon tax on high-emission products to offset cross-border carbon price differences. Vietnam has no national certification scheme of the same weight for coffee or rubber and has not adopted a comparable carbon tax. Its carbon market pilot is the closest equivalent. The gap is therefore not one of intent but of instruments that a foreign regulator can recognise.

TABLE 5

Vietnam has the main instruments in place and delivery capacity is now the constraint

Area	Instrument and date	What it does	Status	Gap we see
Investment: clean energy	Revised PDP8, Decision 768/QD-TTg (15 Apr 2025)	Solar target of 46,459 to 73,416 MW and onshore wind of 26,066 to 38,029 MW by 2030	● Under way	Grid and project speed decide whether exporters get clean power in time
Investment: clean energy	Decree 57/2025/ND-CP on direct power purchase (3 Mar 2025)	Large users can buy renewable power directly from generators	● In force	Contract uptake still limited among small exporters
Investment: green finance	Green Taxonomy, Decision 21/2025/QD-TTg (22 Aug 2025)	Criteria for projects eligible for green credit and green bonds	● In force	Transition loans for exporters still small in scale
Regulation: standards	Amended Law on Product and Goods Quality (1 Jan 2026); Decree 37/2026/ND-CP	Risk-based control; compulsory traceability for high-risk goods; digital product passport	● In force	Data formats not yet aligned with EU product passport rules
Regulation: carbon	Decisions 232 and 263/QD-TTg (2025)	Pilot carbon market for 110 facilities (power, steel, cement) to 2028; national market from 2029	● Under way	MRV and price not yet recognised under CBAM
Regulation: land use	MAE action plan on EUDR (2026)	Provincial forest maps by 31 Dec 2026; risk areas disclosed	● Under way	Land legality and plot data for smallholders

Source: Government of Vietnam; MOIT; MAE; ABrighter Research

On paper Vietnam has moved quickly: most of the instruments that EU buyers will ask about now exist in Vietnamese law. In practice the binding constraint has moved from legislation to delivery. Delivery depends on ministries that share data, provinces that map land, laboratories and verifiers that win foreign recognition and banks that price transition risk. The pilot carbon market illustrates the point. Allowances of 243.1 million tCO₂e for 2025 and 268.4 million for 2026 have been allocated to 34 power plants, 25 steel mills and 51 cement plants, which together account for about 40% of national emissions.³⁵ Whether this becomes an asset under CBAM depends on how it is measured and verified.

The ledger is therefore clear. On the credit side Vietnam has a low-risk EUDR status, a falling rate of food-safety alerts, a growing renewable power base and a legal basis for traceability. On the debit side it has a steel sector with high emission intensity, a smallholder supply base without plot data and verification systems that the EU does not yet recognise. The credit side was mostly built by law and decree. The debit side can only be cleared by investment and by data collected farm by farm and plant by plant.

³⁵Decision 232/QD-TTg (2025) on the carbon market and Decision 263/QD-TTg on allowances for 2025 and 2026; ICAP (2025).

05

The ABrighter Perspective

The enforcement of NTMs by Vietnam's main trading partners, particularly the EU and the United States, will continue to intensify. These partners increasingly put environmental, sustainability and safety standards at the centre of trade policy. The impact runs through the whole supply chain, from sourcing raw materials to production processes and traceability. It forces firms to adapt at several levels at once. This will raise Vietnam's export costs and may become a structural challenge to its long-term competitiveness unless the response is faster than the rules.

We would expect the cost to rise in stages rather than in one step. In the second half of 2026 the pressure will fall on steel data and on EUDR commodities. From 2027 CBAM certificates must be bought and the bill grows with each year of phase-in. From 2030 the carbon cost will be large enough to influence where steel and aluminium products are made. The pressure will not be uniform across sectors, as electronics, the largest export, faces fewer immediate obligations than its size suggests.

Vietnam has accelerated its response. Production restructuring, however, needs an enabling regulatory environment, investment in infrastructure such as clean energy and research and development to advance manufacturing technology. These are the mechanisms that upgrade industries across the supply chain. Several actions are required.

The first is to treat data as national infrastructure. CBAM default values are designed to penalise missing data and EUDR checks require geolocation for every plot. The firm with verified data pays less and the firm without it pays more or cannot sell. Government should fund the shared layers, such as forest maps, land records and grid emission factors, while firms fill in their own.

The second is to price carbon at home in a form the EU recognises. Under Article 9 of the CBAM Regulation an importer can deduct the carbon price effectively paid in the country of origin.³⁶ Every euro that Vietnamese steelmakers pay into a credible domestic carbon market is a euro that need not be paid in Brussels. The pilot that runs to 2028 should be built from the start with MRV that the EU will accept.

The third is to invest in clean energy and cleaner processes. Our scenario shows that moving from Vietnam's average steel intensity to scrap-based EAF cuts the bill at full phase-in from about EUR 407 million to about EUR 81 million a year. Clean power is the precondition, because an EAF running on coal-fired power keeps much of the emissions. The revised PDP8 and direct power purchase under Decree 57/2025 provide the tools.

The fourth is to build capital and skills in the private sector. Upgrading production requires capital investment and human capital. The Green Taxonomy gives banks a common language. It should now be linked to transition loans priced on emission intensity and traceability, with priority for the cooperatives and small processors that supply coffee, rubber, wood and seafood.

The fifth is to strengthen regional cooperation. Harmonised product standards and integrated verification systems across ASEAN would help the region keep its competitiveness in the EU and in other markets that

³⁶Regulation (EU) 2023/956, Article 9: reduction for the carbon price effectively paid in the country of origin.

are expected to expand NTMs. This matters especially for rubber and timber that cross the border from Cambodia and Laos.

One bottleneck deserves plain language. Many smallholders will not fail the EU test because they cleared forest. They will fail because nobody has drawn the boundary of their plot or confirmed that they hold the land legally. Paperwork, rather than deforestation, is the most likely reason a Vietnamese coffee bean is turned away in 2027.

EXHIBIT 10

A three-stage roadmap turns compliance into competitive advantage

	STAGE 1 H2 2026 Comply	STAGE 2 2027 to 2028 Convert	STAGE 3 2029 to 2034 Compete
Government regulation	Finish forest maps and land records; align traceability rules with the EU	Build carbon-market MRV the EU can recognise; incentives for green tech	Domestic carbon price credited against CBAM liability
Exporters production	Verified emissions data; geolocation for every plot and lot	Upgrade processes: EAF, energy efficiency, R&D and skills	Low-carbon, traceable products sold at a premium
Banks and investors	Green Credit soft loans; Green Taxonomy screening of exporters	Finance clean power and direct power purchase (DPPA)	Green bonds and sustainability-linked finance at scale
ASEAN cooperation	Share verification methods and forest data	Harmonise product standards and taxonomies	Mutual recognition with EU verification systems

Notes: Indicative sequencing by ABrighter Research. Each stage builds on the data and capacity of the one before.

Source: ABrighter Research

The outlook is favourable but conditional. Exports to the EU grew by 16.3% in the first half of 2026 even as the new rules arrived. Success will depend on whether Vietnam can deliver verified data, clean power and credible certification within the next 18 months. It will also depend on whether its firms can find the capital to upgrade. Such efforts matter all the more in a world economy where globalisation and free trade can no longer be taken for granted. As the EU's largest trading partner in ASEAN³⁷ with a manufacturing base still growing at around 10% a year,³⁸ Vietnam has everything to play for. The rules from Brussels can be a wall or a bridge. Which one they become will be decided in Vietnam.

³⁷MOIT (2026): Vietnam is the EU's largest trading partner in ASEAN.

³⁸NSO (July 2026): GDP growth of 8.39% in Q2 2026 and 8.18% in H1 2026; manufacturing value added up 10.23% in H1 2026.

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07

Appendix

APPENDIX A

Non-tariff measure classification

Measure type	Group	Chapter	NTM category	Key examples
Import-related	Technical	A	Sanitary and phytosanitary (SPS) measures	Quarantine rules; pesticide residue limits
		B	Technical barriers to trade (TBT)	Product standards; labelling rules
		C	Pre-shipment inspection and formalities	Pre-shipment checks; customs documentation
	Non-technical	D	Contingent trade-protective measures	Anti-dumping; safeguard measures
		E	Licensing, quotas and quantity controls	Import licences; import quotas
		F	Price-control measures	Minimum import prices; additional charges
		G	Finance measures	Foreign-exchange controls; advance payment rules
		H	Competition-related measures	Exclusive import rights
		I	Trade-related investment measures	Local content requirements
		J	Distribution restrictions	Limits on wholesale and retail distribution
		K	Post-sales service restrictions	Restrictions on repair and maintenance services
Export-related	L	Subsidies (non-export)	Production subsidies; tax incentives	
	M	Government procurement restrictions	Preferred suppliers	
	N	Intellectual property measures	Patent and trademark enforcement	
	O	Rules of origin	Origin certification; value-added rules	
	P	Export-related measures	Export licences; export quotas	

Source: UNCTAD; Krungsri Research (2026)

APPENDIX B

Methodology and data notes

Item	Calculation or note
Data cut-off	30 June 2026. Peer comparisons use the 2024 dataset in Krungsri Research (2026) so that all five economies are measured on one basis. Vietnamese national figures for 2025 and H1 2026 come from NSO, Customs, MOIT and industry associations, in most cases as reported by official news agencies because the primary databases were not accessible to us.
EU exposure, 2025	$56.2 / 475.04 = 11.8\%$ of exports; $56.2 / 514 = 10.9\%$ of GDP.
NTM-sensitive exports, 2025	$56.2 \times 81.4\% = \text{USD } 45.7 \text{ bn}$; $45.7 / 514 = 8.9\%$ of GDP. Assumes the 2024 product structure held in 2025.

Item	Calculation or note
Implied cost wedge	Sum over nine items of 2025 export value x AVE proxy = USD 23.3 bn; divided by USD 330.8 bn = weighted AVE of 7.0%. AVE proxies are global averages by product group and not EU-specific estimates for Vietnam.
EUDR exposure	56.2 x 3.9% (coffee) = 2.19; x 1.5% (wood) = 0.84; x 1.3% (rubber) = 0.73; total USD 3.77 bn, or 6.7% of exports to the EU.
CBAM bill	2.08 Mt x intensity x EUR 78/t x (100% - CBAM factor). Full phase-in at 2.51 t = EUR 407 m (EUR 196/t); 2026 = EUR 10 m; 2030 = EUR 198 m. Ignores the benchmark adjustment for free allocation, export rebates and changes in volume, price or intensity. Unit value = USD 1.4 bn / 2.08 Mt = about USD 673/t.
Three-market share	(153.2 + 70.45 + 56.2) / 475.04 = 58.9% of 2025 exports.

Exhibit 3 tiers follow Krungsri Research (2026): 'Very High' for agri-food; 'High' for apparel, textiles, motor vehicles, electronics, machinery and wood products; 'Moderate' for chemicals, metals, rubber, plastics and leather; 'Low' for minerals, oil and gas. Mapping Vietnam's export items to these groups is our own judgement. Footwear is mapped to tanning and leather.

Figures described in the text as our estimate, our calculation or our scenario are ABrighter Research derivations from the sources shown. Their arithmetic is set out above. Peer comparisons use the 2024 regional dataset compiled by Krungsri Research (2026) from Trade Map and CEIC.

APPENDIX C

Glossary

Term	Meaning
AVE	Ad valorem equivalent: the price effect of an NTM expressed as a percentage, like a tariff
CBAM	Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism of the EU
DPPA	Direct power purchase agreement between a renewable generator and a large user
EAFF	Electric arc furnace, which melts scrap or direct reduced iron using electricity
EU ETS	EU Emissions Trading System, the source of the CBAM certificate price
EUDR	EU Deforestation Regulation
EVFTA	EU-Vietnam Free Trade Agreement, in force since 1 August 2020
MAE	Ministry of Agriculture and Environment of Vietnam
MOIT	Ministry of Industry and Trade of Vietnam
MRL	Maximum residue limit for pesticides in food
MRV	Measurement, reporting and verification of greenhouse gas emissions
NSO	National Statistics Office of Vietnam
NTM	Non-tariff measure
PDP8	National Power Development Plan VIII
SPS / TBT	Sanitary and phytosanitary measures / technical barriers to trade
UNCTAD	United Nations Conference on Trade and Development
VSA	Vietnam Steel Association

ABOUT ABRIGHTER

A brighter future for all customers

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ABrighter is an advisory team that helps clients build better organisations. We work with public bodies, consumer businesses and companies going through financial and organisational change. Our team is bound by ethics, integrity and honesty. We treat clients, candidates and employees with the respect they deserve. Our strategy is simple: to become a valued partner that helps each client grow more modern, resilient and sustainable.

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We care about our customers and each other. We serve with humility and transparency.

Courage

We have the courage to step in, speak up and lead by example.

Commitment

We are unwavering in our commitment. We do what is right and work together to get things done.

WHAT WE DO

Strategy and finance control

- Corporate strategy and management vision
- Business portfolio and digital transformation strategy
- Accounting, financial operations and management control

Human capital management

- Talent management
- Personal and organisation development
- Labour and legal HR

Transactions and deals

- Value drivers, operating cash flows and net debt
- Working capital and quality of earnings review
- Pricing, negotiation support and purchase price allocation

Marketing and public relations

- Corporate branding and repositioning
- PR strategy and new product campaigns
- Public affairs and advocacy strategy

HOW WE WORK WITH CLIENTS

01 Design and implement. We take on the client's needs and build an action plan for a better organisation.

02 Define and embed. We embed and sustain the outcomes of the plan and bring best practice into delivery.

03 Mature and evolve. We keep moving with each client as a real partner, assessing and improving as conditions change.

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